shared similar opinions. Their views about political activism ranged from '"*lack of interest*" *to their inability to* "*change politics*" *and finally to the fact that it was not allowed in Islam because* "*women are emotionally weak, and emotional women can't make decisions*"'. The irony of these focus groups in this government university is that being one of the oldest all women's educational institution (that only recently obtained a university status) it produced activists who were the pioneers of the feminist and leftist movements in Pakistan. Their students today were far from being politically active, let alone politically aware. However, given the history of state crackdowns on student politics (as the preceding discussion illustrates), such political apathy or disconnect was also not surprising.

Yet, there were exceptions to the norm. Participants belonging to a minority sect or ethnicity had actively protested for their cause, though these protestors were limited in number. '*Went to a protest against Shia killing. I come from a Shia family so I went to protest against such killings. Went with friends and family and yes we did have an effect but I think if more people had joined, and they do join it can make a difference*' (Focus Group, Private University[34]); '*Yes I have taken part in many protests because I am Hazara and I am facing target killing*' (Student, Female, Quetta). There was this belief that as the affected community they had a responsibility and therefore had to hold the state accountable. The involvement of young Pakistanis, especially those from the Pashtun community in the PTM, but also its appeal to other ethnic groups that have been unjustly treated by the Pakistani state, further highlights the nature of political participation. Organization along ethnic categories is the result of increasing discrimination of particular communities such as the Pashtun and the Baloch by the security state.

Other exceptions towards political participation included those who had been involved in the Tehreek-i-Insaf, having taken part in their dharna, though on further probing through focus groups the extent of their involvement and their belief in the leadership of the PTI was becoming exceedingly problematic. '*Imran Khan makes a lot of silly statements but he also says a lot more than other politicians. I watched a documentary called Pakistan's Shame about child abuse in Pakistan, and there he was seriously addressing the problem. At least he does that*'; '*Sceptical about PTI now but do support Imran Khan*' (Focus Group, Private University[35]).

In one focus group of forty students, thirteen supported PTI, four PML(N) and four PPP, while the majority refrained from acknowledging any political party. Everyone unanimously agreed that they hated politics, with one giving the example of Imran Khan and how her *'hero's character'* had been targeted because he got involved in politics. For others the dharna that was organized